VP OF SALES

GENERAL INFO

PB Technologies is a moderate-sized, publicly traded company. Its specialty is addressing other companies' technological and integration problems. For example, one major client had allowed separate divisions to purchase whatever computing equipment they wanted—Macintoshes and PCs, networked servers for some divisions and no network for others, etc. PB Technologies networked and integrated this company's computing resources over the course of a six-month period, saving the company hundreds of thousands of dollars in redundant data entry.

PB Technologies has experienced growth at or above the industry average for the past five years. The company is facing a number of serious problems. First, a number of major financial decisions have been deferred until the open position of Senior VP for Finance and CFO (chief financial officer) can be filled. Second, the company has experienced explosive growth, causing friction among divisions competing against each other for dominance and leading to a staggering variety of pricing incentives and marketing programs designed by each division.

You are a senior VP at PB Technologies. **Your task is to work with the other senior VPs to recommend to the CEO a Chief Financial Officer for PB Technologies from the attached list of three finalists.** Following is information from (1) their resumes and (2) from subordinates in the division of PB Technologies that you lead.

You should prepare by reviewing your information about the three candidates (about 10 minutes). Once you have done so (and before you discuss with the team), please mark which candidate you prefer on the corresponding line below:

_____Candidate A _____ Candidate B _____Candidate C

After your personal review, you will have 20 minutes to discuss the candidates with management team, after which everyone will vote for the final decision.

RESUME INFORMATION

Candidate A	• Currently: VP of Finance, PB Technologies • Past Positions: ○ Analyst at Price Waterhouse ○ Various positions in the finance division of PB Technologies over the last 18 years • Education: Executive MBA, 5 years ago
Candidate B	• Currently: VP of Finance, Technology Solutions Inc (PB Tech competitor) • Past Positions: ○ Worked for two years in sales for IBM ○ Various managerial positions at Technology Solutions Inc • Education: MBA in finance, 15 years ago
Candidate C	• Currently: Vice President of Accounting and Controller, PB Technologies • Past Positions: ○ Securities and Exchange Commission Analyst ○ Various positions in accounting division at PB Technologies • Education: MBA, 15 years ago; CPA, 19 years ago

VP OF SALES

<u>CONFIDENTIAL</u> INFORMATION FOR SENIOR VP OF SALES

As Senior VP of Sales, you are especially concerned that the new CFO *be extremely knowledgeable about the computer industry and pay close attention to detail*. If the candidate chosen cannot remember all of the pricing and sales incentives available to customers of PB Technologies, that person will not be able to advise you effectively.

The following is information that you have collected from sources within your own division of PB Technologies. <u>Your sources are CONFIDENTIAL, so this information must not be shown to the other members of the top management team. It can be discussed, however.</u>

Candidate A

- Personal attributes
    - Staff complain that candidate can be moody
    - Good at attention to detail
- Other information known about this candidate
    - Completed managerial leadership program sponsored by the company
    - Likes to play chess

Candidate B

- Personal attributes
    - An excellent public speaker
    - Some staff complain that candidate can be moody
    - Detail-oriented personality
- Other information known about this candidate
    - Played a key role in stock issue for Technology Solutions, Inc. 2 years ago
    - Worked in London for two years in the finance division of the European operations of Technology Solutions, Inc.

Candidate C

- Personal attributes
    - Does not remember to recognize the contributions of others once projects are complete
- Other information known about this candidate
    - Completed managerial leadership course offered by the company
    - Organized the farewell tribute to the retiring CFO
    - Extensive international travel and business consulting